PLANNING UNDERWRITING REPORT - PROSPECTIVE

LRD25A/0014W

Newcastle South, Newcastle, Co. Dublin

113 residential units | c. 4.08 ha | LRD route | South Dublin County Council | Submitted 19 December 2025

Outcome status in supplied export: not known as of 8 October 2026.

Permission remains the base case, but the expected planning route looks materially more complex than a clean direct grant. Further Information is the largest identified process risk.

At a glance

Question	Best estimate	What it means
Refusal	**17.5% [16.9-18.2]**	Permission remains the clear base case.
Further Information	**55.0% [53.9-56.1]**	Slightly more likely than not; main process risk.
Third-party appeal	**10.5% [9.8-11.2]**	Risk of an appeal against a grant.
Applicant appeal	**6.4% [5.9-7.0]**	Risk of an applicant appeal after refusal.
Straightforward process	**31.9% [30.8-32.9]**	A clean route to grant is materially less likely than grant itself.
Decision >6 months	**2.4% [2.0-2.7]**	Long delay is not the main concern.

Site-specific read

The proposal is for 113 homes on c. 4.08 ha at Newcastle South under the LRD route. Seven prior applications are recorded within 150 m before submission, but the supplied export does not provide their individual details. Among the closest historical refusal precedents, density and scale dominate, including residential schemes ranging from roughly 20 to 280 dwellings.

Regime caveat: the LRD route replaced the SHD regime in December 2021. The production refusal model was trained largely on pre-LRD applications, so the refusal estimate is informative but more regime-sensitive than the 2018 retrospective case.

1. Chance of getting permission

Best estimate: about 18% refusal risk, or about 82% approval.

Among 12,122 historical applications in the same calibrated risk range, 17.5% were refused. The 95% confidence interval was 16.9-18.2%.

Main estimate	17.5% refused (95% CI 16.9-18.2%; n=12,122)
Wider SDCC baseline	13.1% refusal rate for historical house applications (95% CI 12.4-13.8%; n=8,901)

Interpretation: permission remains clearly more likely than refusal, but the scheme sits above the wider historical SDCC refusal baseline. The LRD regime caveat should remain visible when using the estimate in underwriting.

2. Chance of Further Information

Best estimate: about 55% - slightly more likely than not.

Among 7,819 historical applications in the same calibrated range, 55.0% received Further Information (95% CI 53.9-56.1%).

What FI means: the planning authority pauses the application and asks for extra information, clarification or revised material before deciding the case.

Interpretation: FI is the clearest expected source of planning friction and should be built into programme, design-team and professional-cost assumptions.

3. Appeal risk - third-party vs applicant

The updated model separates the two economically different appeal routes.

Third-party appeal	10.5% [9.8-11.2], n=7,816 - an appeal against a grant.
Applicant appeal	6.4% [5.9-7.0], n=7,833 - an applicant appeal following refusal.

The register does not record party directly; party is inferred from the decision side (appeal against grant = third party; appeal against refusal = applicant).

Interpretation: third-party appeal is the larger of the two risks, but neither is the base case. The split is more decision-useful than a single combined appeal percentage because the consequences arise on opposite sides of the first decision.

4. Chance of a straightforward planning process

Best estimate: about 32% for a grant with no FI, no appeal and no decision lasting more than 12 months.

Among 7,816 historical applications in the same calibrated range, 31.9% achieved that straightforward outcome (95% CI 30.8-32.9%).

Interpretation: the scheme may still be likely to obtain permission, but a clean, frictionless route is much less likely. This gap is the clearest expression of process risk in the report.

5. Chance of a decision taking longer than six months

Best estimate: about 2.4% - low relative to the other process risks.

Among 7,824 historical applications in the same calibrated range, 2.4% exceeded six months (95% CI 2.0-2.7%).

Interpretation: prolonged decision timing is not the main identified risk; FI and the possibility of appeal matter more.

6. Conditions before construction can start

Conditional on grant, the updated model gives an 18.6% probability of at least one pre-commencement condition. The later national reference sample is similar: 16.3% of granted schemes had at least one such condition (95% CI 12.7-20.8%; n=319).

A separate financial-condition family outputs 27.1%, but its validation is weaker. The label refers to planning conditions involving financial obligations, not the financial health of the developer.

7. What had happened on or around this site before?

Seven prior applications are recorded within 150 m before submission.

The supplied export does not list the individual references or outcomes, so this report does not infer a site-history narrative beyond the recorded count. Those applications would be worth interrogating separately if a detailed site-lineage appendix is required.

8. What were similar refused schemes refused for?

Density and scale were the dominant themes among the 12 closest historical refusal precedents.

Application	Theme	Why it is relevant
Meath 2460334	Density / scale	Residential development on c. 1.48 ha.
Louth 2560532	Density / scale	45-unit residential scheme.
Galway 211444	Density / scale	20-unit residential scheme.
Galway 2460729	Density / scale	60-unit residential scheme.
SHD3ABP-313814-22	Density / scale	South Dublin scheme for 280 dwellings, creche and open space.

Eleven of the 12 closest historical refusals were classified as density/scale and one as access/roads. The theme assignment is keyword-based and should guide review of the underlying decisions rather than be treated as a legal conclusion.

Interpretation: this does not imply refusal on density grounds. It identifies density/scale as the dominant issue in the most textually similar historical refusals, making it a sensible priority for detailed precedent and policy review.

9. Scheme-specific counterfactuals

The counterfactual engine tests how this exact submitted scheme moves when a single input is changed. It is a model-sensitivity test, not a causal promise.

Tested change	Change in model-implied refusal risk	Read
79 units	**+0.0 percentage points**	No modelled change
90 units	**+0.0 pp**	No modelled change
101 units	**+0.0 pp**	No modelled change
124 units	**+0.0 pp**	No modelled change
135 units	**+0.0 pp**	No modelled change
146 units	**+2.9 pp**	First tested unit level with a material increase
Add “reduced density with generous setbacks and landscaping”	**-1.6 pp**	Small favourable model sensitivity
Remove drainage/access technical clauses	**+0.0 pp**	No modelled change
Add “including a creche”	**+0.0 pp**	No modelled change

Interpretation: within the tested 79-135 unit range, the model is effectively flat to unit count. At 146 units the model-implied refusal risk rises by 2.9 percentage points. The strongest tested wording perturbation reduces the model score by 1.6 points. These deltas come from the perturbation model and do not replace the calibrated 17.5% headline refusal estimate.

Across the wider wording experiment, the same “reduced density / generous setbacks” phrase reduced model-implied refusal risk by a median 1.9 percentage points and improved the score for 79% of schemes. Other phrase effects were weak, null or unstable; they are not presented as planning advice.

10. If the first application is refused

The longer-run evidence shows that refusal is not necessarily the end of the site, but recovery is far from automatic.

In the matched historical cohort, 59.0% of refused applications were followed by another application on the same parcel within four years. The remaining 41.0% were not resubmitted within four years (95% CI 40.5-41.5%; n=40,172).

Description stayed similar / was trimmed	Subsequent grant rate 91.5% [90.0-92.8] versus 66.9% [66.0-67.9] when absent.
Same planning route retained	Observed subsequent grant rate 82.8% [80.8-84.7].
New technical wording added	Not associated with better conversion in the historical pairs.
Unit reduction	Not used as a general recommendation: the apparent effect reversed in fresh-era testing.

These are historical associations, not causal instructions. They are shown to quantify what historically happened after refusal, not to prescribe a design response.

11. Nearby competing housing supply

Headline pipeline: 2,654 units within 3 km. Expected deliverable within 24 months: about 1,339 units.

Nominal 3 km pipeline	2,654 units
Expected deliverable in 24 months	1,339 units
80% forecast range	778-1,865 units

Interpretation: the central estimate suggests that only about half of the headline local pipeline is likely to become deliverable within two years. This is an aggregate planning/development forecast, not an individual competitor completion-date forecast.

The supplied 36- and 60-month cumulative outputs are not shown because the longer-horizon estimates are non-monotonic and should be reconciled before client use.

12. Local market context

Dublin new-dwelling median price in the six months before submission: €470,000. The middle 50% of transactions lay between €370,044 and €645,000, based on 3,916 transactions. This is descriptive market context only; it is not used to predict planning permission.

13. Overall assessment

Permission remains the clear base case, but the report points to a relatively high probability of process friction before a clean outcome.

- Calibrated refusal risk is about 18%, implying permission remains substantially more likely than refusal.
- Further Information is slightly more likely than not at about 55% and is the clearest identified process risk.
- Third-party appeal risk is about 10.5%; applicant appeal risk is about 6.4%. Neither is the base case, but separating them clarifies which side of the first decision carries the risk.
- A clean outcome is materially less likely at about 32%, even though permission itself remains the base case.
- The LRD route is a material regime caveat because the production refusal model was trained largely on pre-LRD applications.
- Density/scale dominates the closest historical refusal themes and should be a priority for detailed planning review.
- The scheme-specific counterfactuals show little model sensitivity from 79 to 135 units; the first tested material increase appears at 146 units (+2.9pp).
- If refused, historical evidence supports focused revision and shows that resubmission is common, but not guaranteed.
- The nominal 3 km pipeline materially exceeds the modelled 24-month deliverable supply.

Method note

The report shows one customer-facing probability for each question. Where an observed historical resolution rate for the relevant calibrated score range is available, that rate is used as the client-facing estimate and its confidence interval is shown. Raw model scores and validation metrics are omitted where they would create competing probabilities. Small local reference-class percentages are intentionally omitted. Scheme-specific counterfactuals are perturbation-model sensitivities and do not replace the calibrated headline probability or imply causality.

Prospective status

The supplied export records this application as prospective, with outcome not known as of 8 October 2026. No retrospective outcome information is included in this report.